

What's Your Favorite Workout Split?

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Executive Summary

Brandon Carter polls people on their favorite workout splits and makes the case that full body training is superior for natural athletes, citing protein synthesis science and pre-steroid bodybuilding history.

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Street Poll: Favorite Workout Split 0:00

- Several people are asked to choose between common workout splits
 - Upper body/lower body vs. push-pull legs → respondent picks **upper body/lower body**
 - Upper body/lower body vs. body part split → respondent picks upper body/lower body
 - Upper body/lower body vs. full body → respondent picks full body
- The person who chose full body is asked if that's actually what they do
 - They confirm yes, and have been doing full body workouts for over 10 years

The Science Behind Full Body Training 0:23

- Before steroids were invented, every bodybuilder did full body workouts
 - The reason is rooted in how long protein synthesis lasts after training a muscle
 - **Protein synthesis only lasts approximately 48 hours** after a muscle is trained
- The problem with a body part split for natural athletes:
 - If you train chest only one day per week, you are only stimulating protein synthesis once in a 7-day period
 - That means you are missing out on **5 days of potential protein synthesis**
 - Result: you won't grow as much as you could with higher frequency
- Full body training solves this by hitting each muscle group more frequently throughout the week, keeping protein synthesis elevated more consistently



How Steroids Changed Training Philosophy 0:45

- When steroids were invented, athletes discovered they extended protein synthesis significantly longer than the natural ~48-hour window
 - With steroids, you can train a body part just once and muscles will continue growing for the **whole week**
 - This made high-volume, single-day body part splits practical and effective — but only for steroid users (